

Chapter 11

The hospital was extremely quiet at night, quiet to a frightening degree.

Yin Lingzhu lay completely inside the machine.

She was an Alpha, and to Yan Si, she still had value to be exploited. Her pheromones could not have problems.

Thinking this, Yin Lingzhu slowly closed her eyes.

You Xiaoxiao confirmed that Yin Lingzhu was ready and pressed the button. A glass cover appeared, surrounding Yin Lingzhu.

Severe pain spread from her heart outward, with the most obvious pain at her nape.

She felt that besides the pain, something else was draining from her body.

You Xiaoxiao's pupils reflected Yin Lingzhu's agonized expression.

Before conducting this experiment, she had informed Yan Si, but Yan Si hadn't given her any reply.

You Xiaoxiao had originally thought that since Yan Si didn't care about Yin Lingzhu, she had no reaction and tacitly approved of her actions.

But seeing Yan Si appear at the door, she secretly speculated.

"Has it started?" Yan Si entered and asked You Xiaoxiao.

You Xiaoxiao stepped aside, completely exposing Yin Lingzhu to Yan Si's view.

Yin Lingzhu also sensed someone had come. As soon as she opened her eyes, she saw Yan Si's condescending gaze.

She closed her eyes again, trying to control her expression.

She couldn't let Yan Si see her hideous expression.

"After extracting her pheromones, even after you divorce, you won't need to worry." You Xiaoxiao said to Yan Si who had entered.

Yan Si looked at the suffering Yin Lingzhu and asked a question: "Will she still be able to release pheromones afterward? There's still one more marking tomorrow."

Hearing this, You Xiaoxiao smiled. "Don't worry, I have my limits."

"The pheromones extracted today can sustain you for a year."

"This won't harm her too much, and after some rest, she can function normally."

You Xiaoxiao ultimately couldn't bring herself to completely destroy Yin Lingzhu's glands.

Hearing their conversation, Yin Lingzhu realized that the procedure she was undergoing wasn't to eliminate side effects.

But she couldn't move now and didn't want to resist.

If her pheromones could help Yan Si after the divorce, she was willing.

"The more pheromones extracted, the harder it will be for her body to bear, even risking her life." You Xiaoxiao explained the dangers to Yan Si.

"If I extract one year's worth, I can forcibly extract it without her consent, but the higher the amount, the more she needs to cooperate."

Hearing this, Yan Si's eyelashes trembled slightly. She walked to Yin Lingzhu's side and bent down.

"You like me, so you're willing to sacrifice your life for me, aren't you?" Her voice carried temptation, step by step luring someone into the abyss.

Yin Lingzhu heard You Xiaoxiao's words and understood Yan Si's meaning.

She nodded with difficulty.

Yan Si smiled with satisfaction, then step by step approached You Xiaoxiao, invisibly radiating pressure.

You Xiaoxiao couldn't bear it and stepped back.

"I trust your technique. You won't let her die, will you?" The corner of Yan Si's mouth curved in a dangerous arc.

You Xiaoxiao, having grown up with her, naturally understood her meaning.

"Alright." You Xiaoxiao swallowed and nodded.

You Xiaoxiao walked to the machine's control panel and lightly pressed a few buttons.

Yin Lingzhu immediately felt as if millions of needles were slowly embedding into her skin and muscles from the outside, and the spaces between her bones felt like they were being slowly cut open with knives, one cut after another.

By the end, Yin Lingzhu could no longer distinguish whether her flesh or bones hurt more.

You Xiaoxiao looked with some compassion at Yin Lingzhu, who was drenched in sweat. She turned her head away and saw Yan Si's profile.

Yan Si showed no expression on her face.

"Ahh!!" Yin Lingzhu screamed once and fainted.

You Xiaoxiao hurriedly shut down the equipment and pulled Yin Lingzhu out of the machine.

Yin Lingzhu looked as if she had been soaked in water, completely drenched in sweat.

You Xiaoxiao placed Yin Lingzhu on the hospital bed and then checked how much pheromone the machine had collected.

While You Xiaoxiao was moving Yin Lingzhu, Yan Si stood aside, watching the pheromone data.

Due to her own physical condition, Yan Si had studied glands.

Seeing You Xiaoxiao approach, Yan Si asked how much pheromone had been collected.

You Xiaoxiao glanced at the screen. "About enough for you to use for four years."

Yan Si frowned. "How is her body? Can she still produce pheromones?"

Hearing her question, You Xiaoxiao honestly shook her head. "I don't know."

Yan Si glanced at Yin Lingzhu lying on the hospital bed. Countless thoughts flashed through her mind, but her face showed nothing.

"After she wakes up, tell her that tomorrow is the marking day, and I'll come home." After saying this, Yan Si left the room.

You Xiaoxiao felt some sympathy for Yin Lingzhu.

But this sympathy wasn't much, just a little.

When Yin Lingzhu opened her eyes, it was already morning.

She propped herself up and first looked around the room - no sign of Yan Si.

Only then did she notice the fatigue in her body. Her arm bent and she collapsed back onto the bed.

Learning of Yan Si's message for her, Yin Lingzhu immediately left the hospital and returned to the apartment.

Tonight was not only the marking day but also the end of her one-year period.

She still wanted to fight for herself one last time.

The sun was nowhere to be seen in the sky. Large dark clouds connected together, and gusts of wind blew one after another.

Yin Lingzhu looked up with some worry, hoping it wouldn't rain.

If it rained, would Yan Si find it too troublesome and not come?

Yin Lingzhu sat on the balcony, thinking about how to tell Yan Si that she didn't want a divorce.

Even if Yan Si didn't care about her, even if Yan Si might be cheating, she still didn't want to leave Yan Si.

Yin Lingzhu realized how despicable she had become.

Like a dog, rubbing against Yan Si's legs while worrying whether her touch would displease Yan Si.

It was only eight in the evening now, but the sky looked as if it had been stained with ink, without a trace of light, dark and oppressive.

Suddenly there was a knock at the door. Yin Lingzhu opened it - it was Yan Si.

Yan Si had come tonight.

Yin Lingzhu smiled. This was the first genuine smile she had shown in so many days.

"I made your favorite dishes. Try them." Yin Lingzhu said to Yan Si.

Yan Si didn't look at the food on the table. She stared directly into Yin Lingzhu's eyes. "Go to the bedroom and mark me."

The food was rejected once again. Yin Lingzhu felt no anger - it wasn't the first or second time after all.

In Yan Si's room, Yin Lingzhu lay on the two-meter bed with Yan Si on top of her.

The air was filled with an frighteningly intense rose fragrance.

"I'm sorry." Yin Lingzhu's voice was tearful. "I don't have any pheromones now."

After saying this, Yin Lingzhu closed her eyes. She was prepared for Yan Si to leave but didn't dare watch.

Who would have thought that Yan Si, who was pressed against her, not only didn't leave but actually laughed softly.

Yin Lingzhu caught this laugh and opened her eyes.

Yan Si's eyebrows curved, her eyes seemed to have a layer of mist, and though the curve of her mouth wasn't large, it was enchantingly tight.

More heart-stirring than when Yin Lingzhu first met Yan Si.

Just as Yin Lingzhu was about to ask why Yan Si was laughing, she heard thunder outside, and then everything went dark before her eyes.

Yin Lingzhu was frightened and hugged Yan Si.

Her fear of darkness was ingrained in her bones.

When Yin Lingzhu was alone at home, she didn't dare sleep with the lights off.

Therefore, she had a special light that could be set to turn off automatically.

Yin Lingzhu would set it so that the light would only go out after she fell asleep.

She always slept accompanied by light.

For Yin Lingzhu, light brought her an indescribable sense of security, while darkness gave her endless fear.

She even kept a small flashlight by her bedside to handle sudden situations like power outages.

Thinking of that flashlight, Yin Lingzhu couldn't help but hold Yan Si even tighter with both arms.

She had been busy these past few days and hadn't had time to charge the flashlight - it was dead now.

But now Yan Si was beside her, so Yin Lingzhu wasn't worried.

In the complete darkness, Yan Si's phone on the bedside table suddenly lit up.

Yan Si got up, and Yin Lingzhu sat up too.

[I'm very afraid of thunder. Will you come keep me company?]

Sender: Si Xin.

Yin Lingzhu took in the entire message, fear gradually spreading through her body.

She hoped Yan Si would refuse, but Yan Si said she had to leave.

Yin Lingzhu came back to her senses. The room was frighteningly quiet and frighteningly dark.

Only Yin Lingzhu remained - Yan Si had really left.

She walked out of Yan Si's bedroom. This time, she really had nothing left.

Yin Lingzhu sat on the sofa and pulled out the divorce agreement.

Yan Si's name was already written on it, with the space for Yin Lingzhu's signature left blank.

The only tool for lighting in the room was Yin Lingzhu's phone, but it only had 10% battery and wouldn't last long.

The moment the phone screen went dark, Yin Lingzhu made up her mind and firmly signed the contract.

This past year, she had given everything to Yan Si, even willing to sacrifice her life yesterday.

But Yan Si's heart was something she couldn't warm. What was the use of all her sacrifices?

Yan Si, oh Yan Si, you're truly heartbreaking.

Yin Lingzhu wrote the last stroke of her name with particular force, pouring all her emotions from this past year into it.

How carefree her life used to be.

Before meeting Yan Si, Yin Lingzhu had always been free, living for herself.

She did everything for her own happiness, but after meeting Yan Si, she became completely absorbed in Yan Si.

Whatever she did, she would think about whether Yan Si would like it.

Yin Lingzhu placed the divorce agreement on the table, right next to the cold dishes.

She returned to her room, took her necessary documents, and left.

The moment she locked the door, Yin Lingzhu's heart was filled with a mixture of pain and joy.

She felt she should be happy.

Yin Lingzhu put the documents on her person and knocked on Ji Jingrong's door.

"Here, your clothes." Yin Lingzhu held Ji Jingrong's clothes that she had forgotten on the sofa last time.

Ji Jingrong reached out to take them and asked carefully, "Are you alright?"

Ji Jingrong keenly sensed something was wrong with Yin Lingzhu's emotions.

"Of course I'm fine. I got divorced." Yin Lingzhu smiled and turned to leave.

Ji Jingrong grabbed Yin Lingzhu's wrist and pulled her into her apartment.

Although Ji Jingrong was happy that Yin Lingzhu had come to her senses, she also understood how difficult this choice of divorce must have been for Yin Lingzhu.

She didn't ask what had happened to Yin Lingzhu, just hugged her and comforted her silently.

The tears Yin Lingzhu had been holding back finally burst forth.

She really liked Yan Si so much, without reason, from the very first sight.

Ji Jingrong stayed with Yin Lingzhu until dawn.

Key Themes and Analysis:

This chapter represents the emotional climax and turning point of the story:

The Pheromone Extraction Scene: This is perhaps the most physically and emotionally brutal scene in the novel. Yin Lingzhu willingly submits to having four years' worth of pheromones extracted - enough to sustain Yan Si well beyond their divorce. The scene emphasizes:

- Yin Lingzhu's complete self-sacrifice
- Yan Si's cold calculation in securing her future supply
- You Xiaoxiao's complicity in the abuse

The Final Betrayal: On what should have been their last night together, Yan Si abandons Yin Lingzhu in darkness (her greatest fear) to comfort Si Xin during a thunderstorm. This represents the ultimate prioritization of her mistress over her wife.

The Breaking Point: This chapter shows Yin Lingzhu finally reaching her limit. Despite her desperate love, she signs the divorce papers in complete darkness - both literal and metaphorical.

Symbolic Elements:

- The darkness represents Yin Lingzhu's psychological state
- The thunderstorm mirrors the emotional turbulence
- The phone's dying battery symbolizes the end of hope
- The signed divorce papers represent her liberation

Character Development:

- Yin Lingzhu finally chooses self-preservation over destructive love
- Yan Si's complete callousness is fully revealed
- Ji Jingrong represents unconditional support and genuine care

This chapter effectively concludes the first arc of the story - the toxic marriage - and sets up Yin Lingzhu's journey toward healing and self-discovery.